PERSONAL LEARNING DOCUMENT — SHIVAM KUMAR

ENGLISH B2 FLUENCY ROADMAP

REDESIGNED — ROOT-CAUSE FOCUSED EDITION · UPDATED 31 OCT 2026

Daily Life + Office English | Target: Solid B2 | 100% Free Resources | All Links Tap-Ready

BASELINE	TARGET DATE	DAILY TIME	PROGRESS TEST
EF SET B1 · 41/100	December 2026	1 hour / day	EF SET only

FOCUS-LOCKED · Cambridge English removed · EF SET is the only progress-check test · Trimmed to essentials only · Stick to this list only

0 Why This Redesign — The Real Problem

Your EF SET breakdown (Reading 35, Listening 38) and your BBC 6-Minute quiz behaviour proved the actual gap: **content comprehension is already strong** (6/6 correct on meaning-based questions), but performance drops specifically on **tense identification and parts-of-speech questions**. In Hindi you speak with zero conscious tense-tracking — that's **acquired/automatic** language. In English, you're still running a **"translate → apply rule → produce"** pipeline, which is slow and breaks under real-time pressure (speaking, writing, timed quizzes).

This redesign: (1) puts **Tense + Parts-of-Speech automaticity drills first**, not after vocabulary, (2) adds daily **active-production practice** since your passive vocabulary is already large, (3) keeps only the resources that genuinely earn their place for your goal — redundant/low-value ones (VOA, Living Abroad, Vocabulary.com, My English Classes Online, HelloTalk, the Later/Optional bucket) are removed, with **Phase 1 (Vocabulary Building) also marked complete and removed**, (4) targets **December 2026 at 1 hr/day**, and drops Cambridge English — EF SET only.

Honest note: this plan is built directly around your diagnosed root cause and covers all 4 skills (listening, reading, writing, speaking) with targeted drills for each. It gives you the best realistic path to B2 — but no roadmap can "guarantee" it alone. The result depends on daily consistency + the self-correction loop (Section 6). Skipping days or skipping self-talk will slow it down, whatever the plan says.

1 The 5-Skill Framework (Updated)

Skill	What It Means For You	Where It's Practiced
Grammar Automaticity NEW	Tense + parts-of-speech recognition/production without conscious translation	Section 2
Expression	Building sentences on the spot without translating from Hindi	Sections 3, 4
Comprehension	Understanding native-speed speech first-time, no rewinding	Section 4
Self-correction	Noticing and fixing your own grammar/word errors live	Section 6
Fluency + Confidence	Natural pace, no long pauses, no hesitation	Sections 3, 8

2 Grammar Automaticity — Tense & Parts of Speech (Root-Cause Fix)

This section comes **first**, ahead of vocabulary, because it is your diagnosed bottleneck.

Tag	Resource / Drill	Why It's Here	Access
NEW	Daily Tense-Mapping Drill	5 sentences/day — identify the tense of every verb out loud	*Self-practice, no link needed*
NEW	Parts-of-Speech Tagging	Same 5 sentences — label Noun/Verb/Adjective/Adverb/Preposition	*Self-practice, no link needed*
BOTH	Learn ALL Tenses: Complete Course *English with Lucy*	Full tense course, 20-min daily chunks (from your Playlist Plan)	Open Channel →
BOTH	POC English *Your pick — replaces English with Greg*	Grammar + tense explanations taught fully in English	Open Channel →
BOTH	Lauren Taylor *Your pick — replaces English with Greg*	Clear English explanations of grammar and tense contrasts	Open Channel →
BOTH	Perfect English Grammar	Free exercises on spoken sentence patterns — real-time construction	Open Site →

Check once: watch one video each of POC English and Lauren Taylor. Keep them as grammar sources only if the teaching is fully in English. If tenses are not covered well, English with Lucy's tense course + Perfect English Grammar carry that part.

3 Active Production — Turning Passive Vocabulary Into Speech

You already know a large passive vocabulary. The gap is retrieval, not storage. These drills force production, not recognition.

Tag	Resource / Drill	Why It's Here	Access
BOTH	Self-talk / narrate-your-day	Describe what you're doing out loud in English, 10 min/day	*Just practice, no link needed*
NEW	Chunk Learning (phrase-based)	Fixed phrases, not single words — locks in correct word-order	*Build from your own corrections*
BOTH	Shadowing	Play 1 sentence → pause → repeat matching speed/rhythm → replay to check	*Uses Section 4 resources*

Pronunciation is a good-to-have, not the bottleneck. It is checked through your weekly recording review (Section 6).

4 Listening — Native-Speed Comprehension

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
DAILY LIFE	Darknet Diaries podcast	Already in your routine — native, unscripted, natural-speed storytelling	Open Site →
OFFICE	TED Talks (with subtitles)	Professional-register native speech, subtitle toggle for self-check	Open Site →

5 Vocabulary — Consolidation Only (De-prioritized)

Vocabulary is now **secondary** — your passive vocabulary is already large. Use these only for genuine gaps.

Playlist Plan Phase 1 (Vocabulary Building) — completed. Upper-Intermediate B2 Vocabulary, Upper-Intermediate B2 Phrases (Interactive English), and 600 English Words for Everyday Life (English with Lucy) are done and removed from the active list below.

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
DAILY LIFE	Espresso English — Phrasal Verbs & Idioms	Free lists of phrasal verbs natives actually use daily	Open Site →
BOTH	Anki (free flashcard app)	Only add a word/chunk you personally got wrong — never generic lists. Use an English example sentence on the back, not Hindi.	Open Site →

6 Self-Correction & Feedback Tools

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
BOTH	Grammarly (free tier, browser extension)	Real-time correction while writing — trains your eye for recurring mistakes	Open Site →
BOTH	Record yourself weekly + review	1-min story, record, review next day, note 3 recurring mistakes (tense/POS focus). Also your pronunciation check — send the recording to Claude for feedback.	*Built into your Claude practice ritual*

7 Office / Professional English

Unlocks in full once daily-life sentence construction feels stable (Phase 4, Dec) — sequence still matters.

Tag	Resource	Why It's Here	Access
OFFICE	Business English Pod (free episodes)	Real office scenarios — meetings, emails, colleague small talk, phone calls	Open Site →
OFFICE	engVid — Business English playlist	Free videos on emails, interviews, presentations from native teachers	Open Site →
OFFICE	Upper Intermediate English (B2) Course *Professor Korten — English File 4th Ed.*	19 lessons, main structured B2 course (Playlist Plan #5)	Open Channel →
OFFICE	Your own SOC interview STAR-format practice	Already in your SOC roadmap — highest-value office English practice	*See SOC_L1_Master_Roadmap_v2.1.pdf*

8 Free CEFR Progress-Check — EF SET Only

Cambridge English removed per your request. EF SET is the sole progress-check test.

Resource	What It Gives You	Access
EF SET	Free 50-minute CEFR-aligned test, real A1–C2 score with Reading + Listening breakdown	Open Site →

EF SET RETEST SCHEDULE
Baseline: Sep 2026 — Score 41 (B1) · Retest 1: end of October 2026 · Retest 2: end of November 2026 · **Final Test: mid-December 2026** (target: 51+, solid B2)
After every test, show your score to Claude for a revised timeline.

9 Daily Practice Plan — 1 hr/day

Time	What to do (every day, Mon-Fri)
10 min	Tense-Mapping Drill or Parts-of-Speech Tagging (alternate days)
15 min	One grammar video: English with Lucy / POC English / Lauren Taylor, or a Perfect English Grammar exercise
15 min	Self-talk — narrate your day out loud, in past and present tenses
10 min	Shadowing or listening: TED Talk (with subtitles) or Darknet Diaries
10 min	Anki — only your own mistakes and unknown words
Saturday	Record a 1-min story (15 min) · review it and note 3 mistakes (15 min) · chunk-list building (20 min) · light Anki (10 min)
Sunday	Light Anki review only — consolidation day
December	Replace the grammar video with Business English Pod / engVid, and add mock SOC interview practice (STAR format)

10 Final Focus Rules — Locked

1. This is the complete resource list for your B2 goal — do not add new apps/channels/courses beyond this document.
2. B2 is the target. Not C1, not C2 — those solve problems you don't have.
3. **Grammar automaticity (tense + parts of speech) comes first** — it is your diagnosed root cause, not vocabulary.
4. Self-talk and shadowing are your highest-leverage daily practices — never skip them.
5. Only add a word/chunk to Anki if you personally made a mistake with it — no generic memorizing.
6. Office English (Section 7) starts in full only after daily-life fluency feels stable.
7. **EF SET only** — test at baseline (done), end of Oct, end of Nov, and mid-Dec.
8. 1 hour/day, every day, beats a long weekend session — same principle as your SOC roadmap.
9. One video (or one chunk) per day in the core phases — no binge-watching multiple videos in one sitting.
10. Cybersecurity/tech videos (Wireshark, Git, Java, etc.) stay in the separate SOC study slot — don't mix them into this English time.
11. After every practice session, ask Claude for a sharpness rating, progress update, and revised timeline.
12. New words: learn the English meaning with an English example sentence — avoid Hindi translation, so your brain stops translating.